

MEHRDAD FAZLI

CONTACT

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WEBSITES, PROFILES

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<https://mehrdadfazli.github.io/>

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Computer Science,

Expected in 08/2027

George Mason University -

Fairfax, VA

M.Sc. in Systems Engineering,

05/2023

University of Virginia -

Charlottesville, VA

SKILLS

Languages & cloud: Python, SQL,

C++, Bash · GCP (Vertex AI,

BigQuery), AWS (SageMaker),

PySpark

Post-training: Supervised fine-

tuning (SFT), LoRA / PEFT,

knowledge distillation,

reinforcement learning

Agentic AI: Multi-agent systems,

tool use, LLM-driven debugging &

root-cause analysis

Frameworks: PyTorch, Hugging

Face Transformers, scikit-learn

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Forward-thinking, multifaceted, and result-oriented professional, offering broad experience in data mining and analytics. A critical thinker with extreme attention to detail and passionately looking for ways to improve existing procedures. Full-time Artificial Intelligence (AI) enthusiast.

WORK HISTORY

PhD SWE Intern, 5/2026 to 08/2026 – Kirkland, WA

 (Google Cloud Platform)

- Designed and implemented a multi-agent AI framework to automate debugging and root-cause analysis for GCP's backend storage, saving hundreds of engineering hours per year.
- Triageed 20 production incidents over 3 weeks with the framework.

Applied Scientist Intern, 12/2025 to 02/2026 - New York, NY

 (Personalization P13N – Product Intent Team)

- Finetuned LLaMA 3.2 3B and Qwen3 4B (LoRa) using Claude Sonnet 4.5 as the teacher to improve faithfulness and personalization of the generated explanations for the recommended items. The teacher-student distillation framework allowed the student models to achieve a performance on par with the teacher model at a 3X lower latency.

Data Science and Machine Learning Intern, 06/2022 to

08/2022 – Boston, MA

 **Wayfair** (Margin Optimization Team)

- Added confidence intervals to the "demand simulator" estimations of short-term revenue and profit to quantify the uncertainty in the estimations of outcomes (Python)
- Developed an evaluation framework for the "demand simulator" using over 50 million transactions to retrospectively evaluate the accuracy of the estimated outcomes (SQL and Python)
- Created a framework for error decomposition to quantify the contribution of various sources of errors (Python)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Machine Learning - Coursera
- Neural Networks and Deep Learning - Coursera
- Convolutional Neural Networks - Coursera
- Essential Design Principles for Tableau - Coursera

Researcher, 11/2021 to 05/2023 – Charlottesville, VA University of Virginia

- Fitted a partially observed Markov process (POMP, aka HMM) to a synthetic dataset generated via agent-based modeling (ABM) adjusted for the actual COVID-19 prevalence data
- Trained three different probabilistic forecasting neural network architectures, DeepAR, DeepTCN, and TFT, on COVID-19 data and performed feature analysis and data visualization to find the most important features for COVID-19 forecasting
- Demonstrated that viral load guides the forecasting models and improves their accuracy
- Price Optimization Under Local Network Effects: Stochastic modeling of the diffusion of a new product in a network to find the optimal prices

Teaching and Research Assistant, 08/2019 to 05/2021 – Charlottesville, VA University of Virginia

- Trained a deep neural network model to classify a user's activity based on the sensor data from their smartphone and smartwatches
- Assisting undergraduate students in "data and information engineering" and math courses, including "differential equations," "probability," and "statistics" via holding office hours and helping them with the assignments

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Fazli, Mehrdad, Bowen Wei, and Ziwei Zhu. "[CAAC: Confidence-Aware Attention Calibration to Reduce Hallucinations in Large Vision-Language Models](#)" **WACV 2026**
- Wei, Bowen, Mehrdad Fazli, and Ziwei Zhu. "[Making Sense of LLM Decisions: A Prototype-based Framework for Explainable Classification](#)" **AAAI 2026**
- Fazli, Mehrdad, Bowen Wei, and Ziwei Zhu. " [Inject to Heal: Alleviating hallucination in LVLMS via Context Embedding Injection](#)" **ACL 2026**
- Tavasoli, Ali, Mehrdad Fazli, et. al. "[Competitive Pricing Under Local Network Effects](#)" **European Journal of Operational Research (2023)**.
- Fazli, Mehrdad, and Heman Shakeri. " [Leveraging Deep Learning to Improve COVID-19 Forecasting Using Wastewater Viral Load](#)" **IEEE Big Data 2023**.
- Fazli, Mehrdad, et. al. " [Hallucination Mitigation or Conservative Decoding? Rethinking Faithfulness Evaluation in LVLMS.](#)" [**under review for EMNLP 2026**].

AWARDS AND HONORS

- **Outstanding graduate teaching assistant** (GTA) award – computer science department GMU - 2024
- **Best paper** award at 12th International Conference of Intelligent Human Computer Interaction - 2021